Young Trilateral Leaders

Japan-U.S.-ROK Youth Dialogue: Innovation & Resilience

Sendai Regional Event Final Report

October 10, 2026

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Ⅰ. Executive Summary

TogetherWeTri (TWT), a U.S. Department of State Alumni Engagement Innovation Fund (AEIF)-supported youth initiative, convened the U.S.–ROK–Japan Youth Dialogue on Innovation and Resilience in Sendai, Japan. The event brought more than 40 young leaders, U.S. and ROK diplomatic representatives, academic institutions, and local innovators to explore practical trilateral cooperation in digital transformation, disaster resilience, cybersecurity, and community revitalization.

“Japan-U.S.-ROK Youth Dialogue: Innovation & Resilience” was convened under a theme aligned with both objectives, and follows a series of events held across cities in Korea and in Tokyo since 2025. Held on October 10, 2026 at the INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center, this event convened high school students, university students, and early-career professionals with ties to Japan, the United States, and the Republic of Korea. The program opened with congratulatory remarks from Tohoku University, the U.S. Embassy in Tokyo and Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai, followed by two keynote addresses, a four-person panel discussion, and a participant-led group discussion session conducted in parallel Japanese-language and English-language tracks. The event was co-hosted by the INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center and zero to one, Inc., which also provided financial support, and supported by the U.S. Embassy in Tokyo, the Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai, and the City of Sendai.

Speakers emphasized that sustained trilateral cooperation requires translating high-level government commitments into tangible, locally driven initiatives. Participants identified opportunities for cross-border knowledge sharing, AI-enabled disaster preparedness, cybersecurity education, and youth-led regional revitalization. The dialogue demonstrated the potential of alumni-led public diplomacy to connect strategic trilateral priorities with community-level engagement.

Key Discussion Highlights

1. Strengthening Trilateral Cooperation Through People-to-People Ties

Opening speakers emphasized that sustainable Japan–U.S.–ROK cooperation requires engagement beyond government-level dialogue. Professor Masahiro Yamaguchi drew on Tohoku’s post-disaster recovery to highlight the role of people’s actions and innovation in building resilience. Lt Col Robert Everman stressed the importance of translating trilateral priorities into local action, while Deputy Consul General Eunjin Ryu outlined progress in institutionalizing trilateral cooperation and underscored the role of people-to-people exchange in sustaining it.

2. Digital Transformation and Innovation as Tools for Resilience

U.S. Air Force Captain and Mansfield Fellow Claire Park shared lessons from military financial management, emphasizing that digital transformation should improve accountability, data integrity, efficiency, and evidence-based decision-making—not merely automate administrative tasks.

Japanese entrepreneur Takashi Takekawa highlighted the role of locally grounded innovation and entrepreneurship in rebuilding communities following the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake. His remarks reinforced the importance of connecting global expertise with local needs, particularly through education, technology, and youth-driven initiatives.

3. Disaster Resilience and Cross-Border Knowledge Sharing

The panel explored opportunities for trilateral cooperation in disaster resilience, regional revitalization, and healthcare innovation. Speakers highlighted shared challenges and complementary national strengths, emphasizing the importance of youth engagement and sustained cross-border exchange. They identified lasting platforms for dialogue as a foundation for long-term cooperation.

4. Roundtable-Proposed Initiatives: Cybersecurity, Public Health, and Regional Revitalization

During the roundtable discussions, participants developed preliminary proposals for trilateral cooperation and community-level action across three areas:

- **Security:** Establish a youth-led cybersecurity awareness initiative for high school and university students in Japan, the United States, and South Korea. One proposal involved a *Werewolf*-inspired simulation in which participants identify concealed identities using screening guidelines. Discussions also covered online identity fraud and regional security cooperation.
- **Health and Society:** Create in-person forums and community spaces that promote reliable health information, healthier lifestyles, and meaningful social connections. Ideas included ongoing support for healthy habits and offline activities to address excessive smartphone use.
- **Environment and Community:** Advance youth-led regional revitalization through digital marketing, student-managed social media campaigns, international influencer collaborations, homestays, and visits to lesser-known attractions. Participants also proposed more welcoming spaces for junior and senior high school students, supported by diverse organizing teams.

Assessment and Implications

The Sendai event demonstrated the potential to extend Japan–U.S.–ROK cooperation beyond traditional diplomatic and security channels into areas directly relevant to young people and local communities.

Three priorities emerged: sustaining engagement through alumni networks, translating complementary national expertise into practical community-based initiatives, and positioning young people as active designers and implementers of collaborative projects.

The discussion also suggested that smaller, achievable initiatives—particularly cybersecurity workshops, local knowledge-sharing platforms, and youth-led community revitalization projects—could provide practical starting points for sustained trilateral cooperation. Their effectiveness will depend on identifying implementing partners, defining measurable objectives, and establishing follow-up mechanisms.

Key Takeaways

1. From Government Commitments to Local Action: Trilateral cooperation can gain broader public relevance when strategic priorities translate into concrete youth-led and community-based initiatives.

2. Innovation and Resilience as Shared Priorities: AI, cybersecurity, disaster preparedness, and regional revitalization offer practical opportunities for cooperation across the three countries.

3. People-to-People Ties as a Strategic Enabler: Alumni-led initiatives such as TogetherWeTri can help sustain trilateral engagement by connecting emerging leaders, institutions, and local stakeholders.

4. Youth-Driven, Actionable Proposals: Participants identified potential projects in cybersecurity education, digital disaster-response coordination, public health engagement, and regional tourism promotion.

5. Next Step—From Dialogue to Implementation: Future programming should prioritize feasible pilot projects, institutional partnerships, and measurable outcomes to translate the dialogue's proposals into sustained trilateral cooperation.

Ⅱ. Japan-U.S.-ROK Youth Dialogue: Innovation & Resilience

A. Opening and Congratulatory Remarks

Masahiro Yamaguchi | Tohoku University

Speaking on behalf of Tohoku University, Masahiro Yamaguchi welcomed participants and thanked the organizers for bringing together young people from Japan, the United States, South Korea, and beyond. Reflecting on the 15 years since the Great East Japan Earthquake, he emphasized that resilience means not merely recovering from disaster, but building a better and stronger society through both robust systems and individual action. He noted that the disaster reinforced the university's commitment to serving society, a responsibility further underscored by its designation as Japan's first University for International Research Excellence. He concluded that innovation and resilience depend on a shared vision for the future and collaboration across diverse perspectives.

Robert Everman | U.S. Embassy Tokyo

Lieutenant Colonel Robert Everman thanked TogetherWeTri's Japan Branch, the INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center, and the Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai for organizing the event. He highlighted Sendai and Tohoku as examples of resilience and innovation, recognizing how the region has recovered from disaster while fostering new ideas and technologies. He also acknowledged TogetherWeTri members Sora Yamasaki and Tamaki Hoshi as Young Trilateral Leaders alumni turning international exchange into local action. Referring to a meeting in Honolulu where 48 emerging leaders discussed AI, supply chain resilience, and regional technology and infrastructure protection, he noted that the three governments had welcomed such efforts in a joint statement at the UN General Assembly. He concluded that government-level cooperation must be complemented by young people translating shared ideas into meaningful action in their communities.

Eunjin Ryu | Deputy Consul General, Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai

Deputy Consul General Eunjin Ryu welcomed participants joining in person and online and congratulated TogetherWeTri on the event. She emphasized that Japan–U.S.–ROK cooperation supports the security and prosperity of the three countries and the wider Indo-Pacific, spanning not only security but also economic security, emerging technologies, regional cooperation, and people-to-people exchange. She cited frequent trilateral foreign ministers' meetings and the establishment of the Trilateral Cooperation Secretariat in 2024 as evidence of efforts to institutionalize cooperation. While acknowledging shared challenges, including North Korea's denuclearization and maintaining a free and open Indo-Pacific, she highlighted opportunities to leverage the three countries' complementary strengths in

technology and supply chains. She concluded that sustained people-to-people exchange is essential to building mutual understanding and advancing trilateral cooperation.

B. Organizational Overview: TogetherWeTri

Gabi Kim, co-founder of TogetherWeTri, outlined the organization's mission to strengthen ties among young people in Japan, the United States, and the Republic of Korea through public diplomacy and people-to-people exchange.

Inspired by the 2023 Camp David Summit and the first U.S.–ROK–Japan Trilateral Global Leadership Youth Summit in July 2024, TogetherWeTri was founded by summit alumni seeking to sustain trilateral dialogue beyond a single event. After piloting a youth-led session at the Busan American Corner in December 2024, the organization secured funding from the U.S. Department of State's Alumni Engagement Innovation Fund (AEIF) for its current one-year program.

TogetherWeTri has since held eight regional cooperation roundtables, engaging more than 500 young people and university students in Gwangju, Seoul, Busan, and Tokyo. Gabi encouraged participants to view the Sendai event as a starting point for continued dialogue and collaboration among the next generation of trilateral leaders.

C. Keynote Presentations

From Manual Work to Meaningful Work: Leading Through Digitalization — Claire Park | Mansfield Fellow, 30th Class; Captain, U.S. Air Force

Captain Park drew on nearly nine years of military finance experience to explain that successful digitalization should reduce manual work and allow personnel to focus on professional judgment. She identified four key objectives: auditability, data integrity, efficiency, and decision support, serving both service members who require accurate payments and commanders who rely on financial data for risk assessment and resource allocation.

She traced the transition from paper-based processes to the Defense Enterprise Accounting and Management System (DEAMS), an integrated Oracle-based platform that consolidates financial records, improves transparency, and strengthens auditability. While these changes have improved data integrity and efficiency, she identified decision support as an area for further development. Tools such as Power BI are helping automate reporting so personnel can focus on interpreting trends, identifying risks, and advising commanders.

In response to a question about staff training, Captain Park described a combination of online courses, simulations, classroom instruction, on-the-job learning, and written manuals. She

emphasized that practical experience and learning from mistakes are essential to developing proficiency.

Think Global, Build Local, Impact the World — Takashi Takekawa | CEO, zero to one, Inc.; Specially Appointed Professor, Tohoku University

Mr. Takekawa delivered his keynote in Japanese, organizing his career journey around three themes: Think Global, Build Local, and Impact the World. Drawing on his experience in finance, entrepreneurship, and regional revitalization, he emphasized connecting global perspectives with local action.

Think Global. Through his studies at International Christian University and participation in the Japan–Korea Student Forum, Takekawa learned that personal relationships and mutual understanding are essential to dialogue, particularly when political relations are strained. His subsequent experience at Nomura Securities, Harvard Business School, and the Asian Development Bank broadened his global perspective and eventually led him toward entrepreneurship.

Build Local. The 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake became a turning point, inspiring his work in Tohoku. He introduced two initiatives: the Tohoku Food Marathon & Festival, which promotes local producers and regional revitalization, and the INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center, established in 2016 with international support to foster entrepreneurship and social innovation. The center has supported more than 100 social innovators addressing challenges such as population decline, aging, and the sustainability of primary industries.

Impact the World. Through zero to one, founded in 2016, Takekawa promotes AI education, digital talent development, and startup support through industry–academia–government collaboration. He encouraged participants to start with their curiosity and personal experiences rather than wait for a grand plan, defining leadership as making a positive difference—even if it means simply making one person smile.

During the Q&A, he urged students to follow their interests rather than feel pressured to plan their entire futures. He also emphasized that young people are uniquely positioned to address their peers' needs and that speaking up, asking questions, and taking action are themselves expressions of leadership.

D. Panel Discussion: Beyond Borders — People, Innovation, and Resilience

The panel was moderated by Tamaki Hoshi of TogetherWeTri, a participant in the 2024 Young Trilateral Leaders Summit whose work concerns historical questions among Japan, Korea, and the United States. She holds an M.A. from Waseda University in women's history and runs Kotonoha, a Tokyo-based research and writing practice focused on

under-documented histories. The session was deliberately conversational in format and ran in both Japanese and English.

Robert Everman | Lieutenant Colonel, U.S. Air Force; U.S. Embassy Tokyo

Drawing on approximately 17 years of experience in South Korea and Japan, including service in the U.S. Air Force and at U.S. embassies in both countries, Lt Col Everman emphasized that meaningful international cooperation depends on people, not agreements alone. Given the three countries' different histories and perspectives, he stressed the importance of building trust and mutual understanding to translate shared goals into action across generations.

When asked what young people could accomplish within a year, he proposed a digital platform connecting local governments in Japan, the United States, and South Korea to share practical knowledge and strengthen disaster resilience. He noted that AI-assisted development has made building applications and websites more accessible, creating new opportunities for youth-led cross-border collaboration.

He further observed that while the three countries face different challenges and local and national governments may have differing priorities, they share common values. A platform for exchanging local solutions and experiences, he concluded, could help communities learn from one another and develop more effective approaches to shared challenges.

Shosuke Hasegawa | Onagawa Town Regional Revitalization Cooperation Squad

With his experience at a Japanese trading company, Uber Japan, and a U.S. agricultural technology firm, Mr. Hasegawa shared lessons from working across different business cultures before moving to disaster-affected Onagawa, where he now supports startups. He highlighted two complementary practices: the U.S. emphasis on data-driven, objective decision-making and Japan's focus on collaboration, consideration for others, and constructive working relationships.

Turning to regional revitalization and disaster recovery, Mr. Hasegawa identified the low profitability of primary industries as a shared challenge across Japan, the United States, and South Korea. He noted that these industries are vital to regional economies but remain vulnerable to natural disasters, as demonstrated by the loss of farmland and other productive resources following the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake and tsunami.

Taichi Deguchi | Fellow, AN Venture Partners; Resident Physician, Juntendo University Hospital

Born in the United States and raised in San Diego, Dr. Deguchi spent approximately 20 years in the country before attending Tohoku University. Reflecting on how this background

shaped his career, he highlighted the emphasis on initiative, active participation, and pursuing unconventional paths in American culture. He attributed his willingness to take risks and act decisively to these experiences, noting that his own path included beginning martial arts training at an early age, working and conducting research at a U.S. institute after high school, and choosing Tohoku University based on his research interests rather than following a conventional academic route.

Discussing trilateral cooperation in medical innovation, he highlighted the complementary strengths of the three countries: the United States as a major pharmaceutical market, Japan in scientific research, and South Korea in drug development, manufacturing, and commercialization. He suggested that combining Japan's research expertise with South Korea's commercialization capabilities, supported by access to the U.S. market, could help translate more medical discoveries into treatments for patients.

Miku Narisawa | Founder, Odyssey Nature Japan

Ms. Narisawa runs a nature school in Higashimatsushima and conducts doctoral research at Tohoku University in environmental anthropology and ethics. Drawing on her experience of the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake, which destroyed her family home, she described the Disaster Leadership Program she has led since 2023 with support from Japan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs. Inspired by a youth exchange program she attended in Hawaii, she has welcomed high school students affected by the 2023 Maui wildfires and fires near Los Angeles to learn from Higashimatsushima's recovery experience. She emphasized that disaster does not define the end of a person's journey and that opportunities for growth and recovery remain.

Ms. Narisawa highlighted youth exchange as an investment in future community leaders, encouraging young people to address shared challenges such as inequality in education, healthcare, employment, and technology. She also stressed the importance of preserving local knowledge, ecological heritage, and community traditions alongside technological progress.

Closing Exchange

Panelists agreed that within twelve months, establishing lasting platforms for exchange is a more realistic first step than achieving major intergovernmental outcomes. They highlighted ongoing cross-border interaction, including informal activities such as e-sports and craft forums, as a foundation for deeper cooperation. They also emphasized intergenerational learning, encouraging young people to learn from those with decades of additional experience. Sustaining dialogue and mutual learning among young people in Japan, the United States, and South Korea was identified as key to strengthening trilateral ties.

Ⅲ. Proposed Areas of Cooperation

Group Discussion Outcomes

Security: Cybersecurity and International Cooperation

Participants discussed cybersecurity threats, including AI-related risks, cyberattacks, and online identity fraud involving false identities used to obtain remote employment. One group proposed a trilateral cybersecurity education program for high school and university students, featuring a *Werewolf*-inspired simulation in which participants identify false identities using screening guidelines. Discussions also covered international cyber defense cooperation, shared rules for a safer digital environment, Japan's Official Security Assistance (OSA) framework, and maritime security in Southeast Asia.

Health and Society: Healthy Lifestyles and In-Person Exchange

Participants highlighted challenges in accessing reliable health information, excessive smartphone use, and the difficulty of translating healthy intentions into action. Proposals included in-person forums for exchanging information and perspectives, community facilities that encourage healthier habits, and offline activities that foster social connection and reduce reliance on digital platforms.

Environment and Community: Regional Revitalization and Youth Engagement

Participants explored ways to address youth outmigration from Tohoku through tourism and digital marketing. Ideas included student-led social media campaigns targeting domestic and international audiences, collaborations with international influencers to showcase lesser-known destinations, and homestays that offer visitors direct exposure to local life.

To encourage greater youth participation in community activities, participants also proposed creating more welcoming spaces for junior and senior high school students. To address low event attendance, they recommended diversifying organizing teams across regions, genders, and nationalities, while strengthening organizers' understanding of different backgrounds. Participants also expressed interest in continuing cross-cultural exchanges to broaden their perspectives and networks.

Ⅳ. Key Outcomes and Insights

- **Program Outcomes:** Of 40 participants (24 on-site and 16 online), 17 completed the post-program survey (15 on-site and 2 online). This represents a 42.5% response rate overall and 62.5% among on-site participants. All respondents reported high overall satisfaction (4–5 out of 5). In addition, 88.2% reported improved understanding of U.S.–ROK–Japan cooperation, 82.4% a clearer understanding of its importance, and 94.1% increased interest in trilateral cooperation. While only 35.3% rated their prior

familiarity with trilateral relations at 4–5, 47.1% rated it at 1–2, suggesting that the program effectively engaged participants with limited prior knowledge. Overall, 94.1% expressed willingness to join future TogetherWeTri programs, including 70.6% who selected the highest rating.

- **Outreach Metrics:** The team contacted 65 organizations and 9 individual faculty members and practitioners across Sendai and the wider Tohoku region, establishing 71 direct contact points. The organizations included 11 higher-education institutions, 29 secondary schools, 13 student and youth organizations, 7 civic, NPO, and public institutions, and 3 regional and student media outlets. Outreach extended to Fukushima and Iwate and included national youth networks, laying groundwork for continued regional engagement and people-to-people cooperation.

- **Audience Composition:** The event brought together participants from high school through early-career professional stages, including university students, graduate researchers, clinical residents, and industry professionals. Seven of the 24 on-site participants had backgrounds in health and medicine, aligning with the health and society theme and discussions of trilateral biomedical innovation. Participants represented Japan, the United States, and South Korea, as well as China and India, bringing diverse perspectives to the dialogue. (See Section V-A for the full composition.) 16 people participated online, including 5 from South Korea and 1 from India. Retaining a hybrid option could help future convenings reach participants who cannot attend in person.

- **Bilingual Program Design:** Bilingual communication was integrated throughout the program to support participation in both Japanese and English. The keynotes were delivered in different languages, so neither language served as the default. Speaker introductions and announcements were bilingual, the panel moderator switched languages according to each panelist's preference, and AI simultaneous interpretation was available throughout. Participants could also choose Japanese- or English-language group discussions covering the same three themes. The groups reached convergent conclusions on health and society, suggesting that the parallel format supported substantive engagement across language groups. One participant described attending a specialized lecture in English for the first time as a valuable experience, illustrating the potential of bilingual programming to broaden access.

- **Place-based Specificity:** Holding the event in Tohoku produced content that an event in Tokyo would not have generated. Disaster resilience, the viability of primary industries, population outflow from the region, and post-disaster educational continuity were raised by participants with direct experience of them, including a

panelist whose family home was destroyed in 2011 and who now runs disaster leadership programming for students from Hawaii and California.

- **Areas for Improvement:** Feedback identified two priorities. First, outreach to university students could be expanded. One respondent noted that "not many students knew about it" and recommended wider circulation among Japanese and international students. Second, participants wanted more time for discussion and Q&A. Audience questions were limited after both keynotes, and the panel reached its final segment with only four minutes remaining. Future events could address these issues through more targeted university outreach and additional time for audience interaction.

Reflections from the organizing team

- Gabi Kim: As a co-founder of TogetherWeTri, I was particularly impressed by Sendai's strong regional identity, community pride, and commitment to youth development. The region's experience with the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake and ongoing challenges of youth outmigration and regional revitalization closely resonated with the event's theme of Innovation and Resilience. Strong participant engagement, coupled with the ROK Consulate General in Sendai's interest in future YTL collaboration and Tohoku University's commitment to international exchange, highlighted significant potential for sustained trilateral engagement. As a follow-up, TogetherWeTri could explore organizing a U.S.–Japan–ROK youth journalist familiarization (FAM) tour to document Sendai's resilience and revitalization efforts, while engaging previous participants as volunteers to sustain youth involvement and expand people-to-people ties.

- Seoyoung Lee: From the beginning, we have aimed to explore U.S.–ROK–Japan trilateral cooperation through questions rooted in each region's unique identity and challenges. Discovering the sister-city connections between Gwangju, Sendai, and San Antonio made this journey even more meaningful, offering a tangible way to connect local communities across the three countries. For Sendai, a city shaped by its experience with natural disasters and recovery, we focused on innovation and resilience, exploring how local communities can transform challenges into opportunities for sustainable development. On a personal note, it was a pleasure to reconnect with Miku Narisawa, founder of Odyssey Nature Japan, whom I had the privilege of meeting at the 2026 Alumni Workshop in Honolulu, and to welcome her as one of our speakers. While I was primarily responsible for managing the online and hybrid seminar, this experience reminded me how to bring shared dialogue and the passion to turn ideas into action.

- Ryan Son: Over the past year, I have found myself asking a simple question after each TogetherWeTri program: what happens next? Sendai offered a promising answer. Our

Japan team built new relationships in Tohoku, brought together speakers with deep ties to the region, and gave participants an opportunity to develop practical ideas on cybersecurity, public health, and regional revitalization. I am especially proud of Sora and our colleagues for taking the initiative and bringing this program together. Moving forward, I hope we can build on these new partnerships, develop some of the proposals into concrete initiatives, and continue creating opportunities for young people across our three countries to work together. TogetherWeTri began with the belief that trilateral cooperation should extend beyond any single summit or dialogue. Seeing our colleagues carry that commitment into new communities has been one of the most rewarding parts of this journey.

- Sora Yamasaki: Organizing this event was an opportunity to address a concern I had felt during my university years in Sendai: many motivated young people may have fewer opportunities to access information and engage with diverse perspectives than their counterparts in Tokyo. I am encouraged that the event brought together participants from Japan, the United States, South Korea, and beyond, with support from government-related institutions in all three countries. Although I initially worried that an English-language event might discourage participation, the bilingual format proved effective, and one participant's comment that attending a specialized lecture in English was a valuable experience was particularly meaningful. With strong on-site attendance despite the three-day holiday and interest in future events from both participants and the Korean Consulate, I hope this convening marks the beginning of continued engagement in Sendai and new opportunities for young people to contribute to trilateral cooperation.

- Tamaki Hoshi: Organizing and participating in this event offered a refreshing perspective on the potential of trilateral cooperation, particularly when it is rooted in local communities. One participant stayed after the event to express his gratitude for having such an opportunity in Sendai, a comment that resonated with me. As someone living in Tokyo, I had not fully considered how valuable access to these discussions could be for people in regional areas, and I was glad to see the event make that possible. The speakers' strong connections to the region and their inspiring perspectives demonstrated how meaningful it can be to bring international dialogue directly to local communities, where it can address local needs and create opportunities that might not otherwise arise. I also found the bilingual group work in both English and Japanese particularly valuable. While AI and translation tools can help bridge language barriers, my experience as a bilingual staff member reinforced my belief that in-person communication and human connection remain essential to building mutual understanding and trust. I hope this event will encourage further opportunities to connect diverse perspectives through meaningful, locally grounded trilateral engagement.

- Aruto Masuda: Organizing this event was an opportunity for me to connect my two important axes: regional revitalization and the ROK-U.S.-Japan Trilateral cooperation. Through my internship with a local fishery startup in Miyagi Prefecture, I came to recognize Japan's regional areas, especially Tohoku, as a suitable incubator for trailblazing startups. I am glad to have been part of this project, creating a venue where local aspiring youth can listen to and converse with young business pioneers. I am delighted to have read reflections from participants, who shared how this event gave them a chance to find role models. My sincere gratitude goes to the organizing team, especially our amazing leader, Sora Yamasaki, as well as our guest speakers, sponsors, participants, and everyone who made this event possible. Hopefully, this project will continue and bear more fruit in the foreseeable future.

Ⅴ. Monitoring and Evaluation

A. Beneficiaries

Direct Beneficiaries

The project directly engaged 55 individuals: 40 participants (24 on site and 16 online), 8 invited speakers, and 7 TogetherWeTri members (5 on site and 2 online). Participants engaged in the program’s opening remarks, two keynote addresses, panel discussion, and parallel Japanese- and English-language group discussions.

The 24 on-site participants represented diverse educational and professional backgrounds: 13 university students and graduate researchers, 5 high school students, 3 clinical residents, a Blakemore Japan Fellow at the Stanford Inter-University Center for Japanese Language Studies, an IT engineer at a Sendai-based firm, and a content creation professional. Eight university students and researchers were affiliated with Tohoku University, spanning medicine, dentistry, humanities, and doctoral study. Others came from Tohoku Gakuin University, Sendai University, Sendai Shirayuri Women’s University, and Waseda University. Participants came from Miyagi Prefecture and beyond, including Tokyo and Yokohama, and included international students and the president of the Tohoku University Korean Students Association.

By nationality, the on-site cohort included 15 participants from Japan, 5 from the Republic of Korea, 2 from China, and 1 from the United States, alongside 1 participant who identified ties to Japan, the United States, and the Republic of Korea. The online cohort included 8 participants from Japan, 5 from the Republic of Korea, and 3 from other countries, including the United States and India.

Indirect Beneficiaries

Indirect beneficiaries include individuals reached through pre- and post-event dissemination and informal knowledge-sharing networks. Promotion through official social media channels reached 2,470 accounts and generated 7,726 views, extending the reach of the program well beyond those who attended.

B. Local Partners

- **INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center.** Co-host. Provided the venue and operational support. Established in 2016 with funding committed by the State of Qatar for post-disaster reconstruction, the center has supported more than one hundred social innovators in partnership with the City of Sendai and Tohoku Electric Power, and served as the natural hub for a convening on resilience and innovation.

- **zero to one, Inc.** Co-host. Contributed support for the program and the CEO provided the second keynote address. The company works on AI and digital talent development through industry–academia–government collaboration, including programming with the City of Sendai.

- **Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai.** Supporting institution. Delivered congratulatory remarks situating the convening within the trilateral framework and within the Consulate General's own regional programming, in a year marking the sixtieth anniversary of its establishment.

- **U.S. Embassy.** Supporting institution. Lt Col Robert Everman of U.S. Embassy Tokyo participated as a panelist, and youth program specialist Noyuri Mitsuhashi visited the event.

- **City of Sendai.** Supporting institution. Supported outreach by displaying the event poster on their bulletin board.

- **Tohoku University.** Delivered congratulatory remarks. The university is a founding partner of INTILAQ and is referenced throughout the program as a regional anchor institution.

C. Media and Public Outreach

Bilingual outreach materials included an event poster, registration form, and separate reminders for in-person and online participants. An English-language invitation was also sent to participants of previous convenings in Korea and Tokyo.

Digital promotion was conducted through TogetherWeTri's social media, alongside outreach to regional and student media and student organizations. Outlets contacted included Sendai Tsushin, and several university's student publications. Instagram promotion reached 2,470

accounts and generated 7,726 views, 43 likes, 19 shares, and 60 profile visits. The shares helped extend the event's reach beyond TogetherWeTri's immediate audience.

A Japanese-language press release outlined the program, speakers, and media attendance arrangements. With assistance from panelist Miku Narisawa, the Miyagi Prefectural Government's International Policy Division also circulated event information to the Prefectural Government Press Club, extending outreach through regional public-sector channels.

Ⅵ. Conclusion

The Sendai Regional Event demonstrated how Japan–U.S.–ROK cooperation can move beyond high-level dialogue toward practical, locally grounded action. Participants identified shared challenges and complementary strengths across the three countries, developing preliminary proposals in cybersecurity, health and society, and regional revitalization.

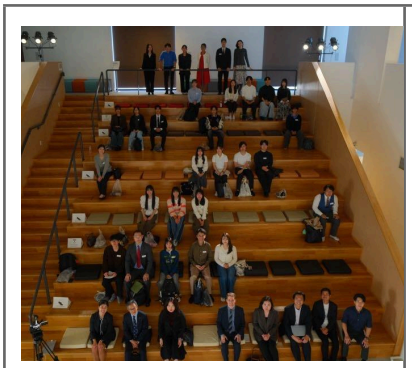
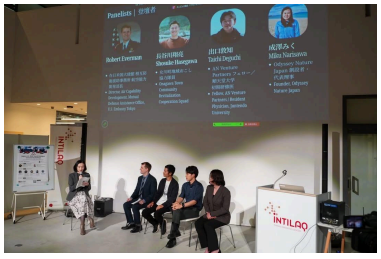
As TogetherWeTri's first fully bilingual convening and its first event in Japan outside Tokyo, the program tested an inclusive format combining bilingual presentations, moderation, and parallel Japanese- and English-language discussions. Holding the event in Tohoku connected trilateral dialogue with regional priorities, including disaster recovery, demographic change, and community resilience. Participants ranging from high school students to professionals brought diverse perspectives to these discussions.

Outreach remained a key challenge. Contacting 65 organizations and 9 individuals in a region where TogetherWeTri had no established presence required substantial effort, and participant feedback pointed to the need for stronger university outreach. Nevertheless, the event established new relationships with regional institutions and partners, while 94.1% of survey respondents expressed interest in future programs, providing a foundation for continued engagement in Tohoku.

The event reinforced that sustained trilateral cooperation depends on people turning shared priorities into action. TogetherWeTri's next step is to develop the roundtable proposals into feasible follow-up activities, strengthen regional and university partnerships, and apply lessons from the event to future programming. These efforts can help build lasting, bottom-up cooperation among the next generation of leaders in Japan, the United States, and South Korea.

Ⅶ. Appendix

Appendix A. Photos and Videos

		
Group Photo	*Group Photo (TWT members, Panelists, Speakers)*	*During Opening Remark (Prof. Yamaguchi)*
		
During Opening Remark (Deputy Consul General Ms. Ryu)	*Keynote Speech I (Claire Park)*	*Keynote Speech II (Takashi Takekawa)*
		
Panel Discussion	*Panel Discussion*	*Group Discussion*

Appendix B. Poster



Appendix C. Program

14:00–14:20 Opening and Congratulatory Remarks

14:20–15:30 Part I — Keynote Addresses (Claire Park; Takashi Takekawa)

15:40–16:20 Part II — Panel Discussion: Beyond Borders — People, Innovation, and Resilience

16:25–16:55 Part III — Group Discussion: From Here to the World — Turning Ideas into Action

16:55–17:00 Closing

Host: TogetherWeTri Japan Branch | Co-hosts: INTILAQ Tohoku Innovation Center, zero to one, Inc.

Supported by: U.S. Embassy, Consulate General of the Republic of Korea in Sendai, City of Sendai